IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 01

HOME

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you live in a house or a flat?
- What is your favourite room at home, and why?
- Would you like to move to a different home in the future?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe your ideal house.

You should say:

- where it would be
- how big it would be and what rooms it would have
- who would live there
- why it is ideal for you

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- Why do many people in big cities live in flats?
- How has housing changed in your country over the last few decades?
- Should governments help young people buy their first home?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “home” card

- A house or flat you would like to live in
- A room in your home that you like
- A place you lived in when you were a child
- A piece of furniture you like at home
- A home you visited and liked
- A time you moved to a new place
- A place where you like to relax at home
- A neighbour you know

Where it would be → **What** size and rooms → **Who** would live there → **Why** it is ideal for you

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Describing the house and its location

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 a cosy atmosphere

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

shinam, issiq muhit • *a warm, comfortable feeling in a room that makes you relax*

BAND 8 STORY

The first thing guests notice in my aunt's flat is the **cosy atmosphere**. She uses warm lamps instead of bright ceiling lights, so even on freezing January nights in Tashkent everyone ends up chatting for hours over tea.

≈ **a homely feel** — uyga xos iliq his

≈ **a warm and welcoming vibe** — iliq va samimiy muhit

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xona yoki uyning qulay va iliq hissini tasvirlashda ishlating: create/have a cosy atmosphere. Part 1 va Part 2 da uy tasviri uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: I prefer candles and soft cushions because they give the room **a cosy atmosphere** that a bright ceiling light never could.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 open-plan kitchen

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

oshxona va mehmonxonasi birlashgan ochiq rejali oshxona • *a kitchen with no wall between it and the living area*

BAND 8 STORY

When we renovated, we chose an **open-plan kitchen** so Mum could cook plov and still chat with guests in the living room. It sounds like a small change, but it has made our family dinners much livelier.

≈ **an open-plan layout** — ochiq rejalashtirish

≈ **a kitchen-diner** — oshxona-ovqatlanish xonasi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uy rejasini tasvirlashda: an open-plan kitchen / living area / layout. Ko'pincha 'with' bilan keladi: a flat with an open-plan kitchen.

Namuna gap: I'd love a flat with an **open-plan kitchen**, because cooking is much more fun when you are still part of the conversation.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 a stone's throw from

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yonginasida, juda yaqin • *very close to a place, only a short distance away*

BAND 8 STORY

Our flat is **a stone's throw from** the metro, so I never worry about being late for classes. Better still, the little bakery downstairs sells hot non every morning, and the smell alone is enough to wake me up.

≈ **right next to** — ayni yonida

≈ **within easy reach of** — oson yetib boriladigan masofada

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uy joylashuvini aytishda: a stone's throw from + joy. Norasmiy va jonli ibora, Part 2 da joy tasvirlashda juda yaxshi ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: My dream house would be **a stone's throw from** the sea, so I could swim before breakfast.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 floor-to-ceiling windows

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

pol'dan shiftgacha katta derazalar • *very tall windows that go from the floor to the roof of a room*

BAND 8 STORY

My ideal living room has **floor-to-ceiling windows** facing the mountains. I imagine drinking tea there at sunrise, watching the light slowly change on the snow, and honestly, no painting could ever compete with that view.

≈ **panoramic windows** — panoramali derazalar

≈ **a wall of glass** — butun devor shisha

Qachon ishlatiladi: Zamonaviy, yorug' uyni tasvirlashda: with / have floor-to-ceiling windows. Odatda ko'plik shaklida va 'with' bilan ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: The architect designed the house with **floor-to-ceiling windows** so every room feels bright and connected to the garden.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 plenty of natural light

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko'p tabiiy yorug'lik • *a lot of sunlight coming into a room*

BAND 8 STORY

I chose my bedroom because it gets **plenty of natural light** in the morning. I used to study in a dark room and felt sleepy all day, but now I wake up fresh and my mood is completely different.

≈ **flooded with light** — yorug'likka to'lgan

≈ **bright and airy** — yorug' va havodor

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xona yorug'ligini maqtashda: get / let in plenty of natural light. 'Light' bu yerda sanalmaydigan ot: plenty of light (lights emas).

Namuna gap: Large windows let in **plenty of natural light**, which saves electricity and lifts my mood.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 spotlessly clean

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

tip-tiniq toza • *extremely clean, without any dirt at all*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandmother keeps her house **spotlessly clean**, even though she is nearly eighty. Every Friday she washes the carpets in the yard, and guests always say they could eat off her floor.

≈ **immaculate** — benuqson toza

≈ **neat and tidy** — ozoda va tartibli

Qachon ishlatiladi: Adverb + adjective birikmasi: spotlessly clean. 'Very clean' o'rniga ishlating; uy va oshxona tozaligini tasvirlashda Part 1 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Mum insists that the kitchen must be **spotlessly clean** before anyone is allowed to go to bed.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 overlook

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

(derazasi) ...ga qaragan bo'lmoq • *to have a view of something from above or from a window*

BAND 8 STORY
My dream bedroom would **overlook** a quiet garden full of apricot trees. In spring I'd open the window and hear the birds, and I'm sure I would never need an alarm clock again.

≈ **look out onto** — ...ga qaragan

≈ **have a view of** — ...manzarasi ochilgan

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l) e'tibor bermay o'tkazib yubormoq — I almost **overlooked** the small mistake in the contract.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Overlook + joy, 'on' yoki 'to' siz to'g'ridan-to'g'ri ishlatiladi: The balcony overlooks the park. Ko'pincha 'with a view' o'rniga yaxshi alternativ.

Namuna gap: Our balcony **overlooks** the old market, so the whole street feels alive on weekends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 a quiet residential area

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

tinch yashash mavzesi • *a calm part of a town where people mostly live, not work or shop*

BAND 8 STORY
We moved to **a quiet residential area** on the edge of Samarkand when I was ten. There was hardly any traffic, so I could ride my bike with the neighbours' kids until sunset, and those evenings are still my best memories.

≈ **a leafy suburb** — daraxtzor chekka mavze

≈ **a peaceful neighbourhood** — tinch mahalla

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uy joylashgan hududni tasvirlash: live in a quiet residential area. Part 1 dagi 'Where do you live?' savoliga 'It's in a...' deb javob boshlang.

Namuna gap: Many families prefer **a quiet residential area** because it is safer for children.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 within walking distance of

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

piyoda borsa bo'ladigan masofada • *close enough to reach on foot*

BAND 8 STORY
Our house is **within walking distance of** my university, which saves me nearly an hour on the bus every day. I use that time to sleep a little longer, and I really notice the difference during exam season.

≈ **a short walk from** — bir necha daqiqalik piyoda yo'l

≈ **on the doorstep** — ostonaning o'zida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Within walking distance of + joy: ...of the bazaar. 'of' ni unutmang ('to' emas). Joylashuv va qulaylikni tushuntirishda Part 1/2 da foydali.

Namuna gap: It's convenient to live **within walking distance of** shops, a pharmacy and a park.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 a well-equipped kitchen

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

hamma kerakli jihozi bor oshxona • *a kitchen that has all the machines and tools you need*

BAND 8 STORY

Since I love baking, my ideal home must have **a well-equipped kitchen**. Last winter I tried making samsa in our tiny kitchen with one pan, and it was a disaster, so now I dream about a big oven and lots of counter space.

≈ **a fully fitted kitchen** — to'liq jihozlangan oshxona

≈ **a state-of-the-art kitchen** — eng zamonaviy oshxona

Qachon ishlatiladi: Well-equipped boshqa joylarga ham mos: a well-equipped gym / lab / office. 'Ideal house' mavzusidagi Part 2 javobida foydali sifatlash.

Namuna gap: Foodies like me appreciate **a well-equipped kitchen** more than a big garden.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 unwind

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

dam olmoq, charchoqdan chiqmoq • *to relax and let stress go*

BAND 8 STORY
After a long day at work, I **unwind** on the sofa with a cup of green tea. Within ten minutes my shoulders drop and my phone stays silent, which is exactly what I need to face tomorrow.

≈ **wind down** — tinchlanmoq

≈ **chill out** — dam olmoq (norasmiy)

Qachon ishlatiladi: To‘g‘ridan-to‘g‘ri fe’l: I unwind by + -ing yoki unwind with + ot. Uydagi dam olishni tasvirlashda eng foydali fe’l; ‘relax’ dan ko‘ra boyroq.

Namuna gap: Nothing helps me **unwind** like cooking dinner while my favourite playlist is on.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 kick back

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

oyoq cho‘zib dam olmoq • *to relax in a casual, lazy way*

BAND 8 STORY
On Sundays, my brothers and I just **kick back** in the living room and watch football. Nobody cooks anything complicated, nobody argues about chores, and that lazy day is what keeps us sane during the week.

≈ **put my feet up** — oyoqni uzatib dam olmoq

≈ **lounge around** — bekor yotib dam olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy iboradir: kick back and relax / kick back with friends. Part 1 da yaxshi, lekin rasmiy yozuvda ishlatmang.

Namuna gap: At weekends I like to **kick back** on the balcony with a book and a glass of juice.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 feel at home

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini uyidagidek his qilmoq • *to feel comfortable and relaxed in a place*

BAND 8 STORY
When I first moved to the dormitory, I didn’t **feel at home** at all. But after my roommates cooked plov for the whole floor, the place finally felt like mine.

≈ **settle in** — joylashib, ko‘nikib olmoq

≈ **feel right at home** — aynan o‘z uyimdagidek his qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi joyda yoki mehmonxonada: feel at home (at the home emas!). ‘Home’ oldida artikl qo‘yilmaydi. Part 1 va 2 da joyga bog‘liqlikni tasvirlaydi.

Namuna gap: Warm colours and family photos make a stranger **feel at home** the moment they walk in.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 home sweet home

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

uydek joy yo‘q • *a phrase said with pleasure when you are back in your own house*

BAND 8 STORY

After two weeks of backpacking, I dropped my bag in the hall and sighed happily, ‘**Home sweet home**’. Even the creaky floor sounded welcoming. I slept for twelve hours straight.

≈ **there’s no place like home** — uydan yaxshi joy yo‘q

≈ **east or west, home is best** — o‘z uying - o‘lan to‘shaging

Qachon ishlatiladi: Safardan qaytganda aytiladigan qisqa ibora. Hazil yoki iliq ohangda ishlating va juda ko‘p takrorlamang; asosan Part 1 uchun.

Namuna gap: Whenever I come back from a business trip, the first thing I say is ‘**Home sweet home**!’

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 creature comforts

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kundalik qulayliklar • *small things that make life at home easy and pleasant*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m not a luxury person, but I do need my **creature comforts**: a soft bed, hot water and decent Wi-Fi. When our water was cut for three days last summer, I realised how much I take them for granted.

≈ **home comforts** — uy qulayliklari

≈ **mod cons** — zamonaviy qulayliklar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Doim ko‘plikda: enjoy / miss one’s creature comforts. Safardan keyin yoki qulayliklarning yo‘qligini tasvirlashda yaxshi ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: Camping is fun for a weekend, but after that I miss my **creature comforts**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 a sense of belonging

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini shu yerga tegishli his qilish • *the feeling that you are accepted and part of a place or group*

BAND 8 STORY

In our mahalla, everyone knows everyone, so I grew up with **a sense of belonging**. If I came home late, three neighbours would ask if I was OK, which was annoying then but touching now.

≈ **a sense of community** — jamoaviylik hissi

≈ **a feeling of connection** — bog‘liqlik hissi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mavhum, lekin Band 8 uchun kuchli ibora: give people a sense of belonging / develop a sense of belonging to. Part 2 sabablari va Part 3 da.

Namuna gap: A home is more than walls; it gives you **a sense of belonging** that no hotel can offer.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 make yourself at home

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zingizni uydagidek tuting • *a polite way to tell a guest to relax and use things freely*

BAND 8 STORY
When my friend from Tokyo visited, I told her to **make herself at home** and showed her where the tea and blankets were. By the second evening she was cooking in our kitchen like a family member.

≈ **treat the place as your own** — bu joyni o‘zingizniki deb biling

≈ **feel free** — tortinmang

Qachon ishlatiladi: Mehmonga aytiladigan odobli ibora. Shaxsga qarab o‘zgaradi: make myself / himself / themselves at home. Mehmondo‘stlik haqida gapirishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Uzbek hospitality means guests are always told to **make themselves at home**, and the table is never empty.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 cosy up

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

yumshoq, issiq joyga o‘ralib yotmoq • *to get warm and comfortable, often with a blanket*

BAND 8 STORY
When it snows, I love to **cosy up** under a thick blanket with a book and hot tea. My little sister usually joins me, and we stay like that until Mum calls us for dinner.

≈ **curl up** — g‘ujanak bo‘lib yotmoq

≈ **snuggle up** — bag‘riga siqilib yotmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(norasmiy) kimgadir xushomad qilib yaqinlashmoq (cosy up to) — He keeps trying to **cosy up to** the boss.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Phrasal verb: cosy up on the sofa / with a book. Qishdagi uy muhitini tasvirlashda yaxshi. ‘Cosy up to‘ esa boshqa ma’noga ega.

Namuna gap: On rainy days I just **cosy up** on the sofa and watch old films.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 cook up a storm

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko‘p va mazali ovqat pishirmoq • *to prepare a lot of tasty food with energy and skill*

BAND 8 STORY
Whenever relatives visit, my mother **cooks up a storm**. By the time we arrive, the table is full of plov, samsa and three kinds of salad, and I always eat far more than I planned.

≈ **whip up a meal** — tezda ovqat tayyorlamoq

≈ **rustle up** — bor narsadan tez ovqat qilmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(bahona, reja) to‘qib chiqarmoq — He **cooked up** an excuse for being late.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy idioma: cook up a storm for guests / at the weekend. Part 1 dagi ‘Do you like cooking?’ va oila haqidagi savollarda juda mos.

Namuna gap: My dad loves to **cook up a storm** on weekends, and the whole kitchen smells amazing.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 the heart of the home

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

uyning markazi, jon-dili • *the room or place where family life mostly happens*

BAND 8 STORY

In our house, the kitchen is **the heart of the home**. We do homework at the table, argue about football over breakfast, and every important family decision has been made there.

≈ **the hub of the house** — uyning markazi

≈ **the focal point** — asosiy markaz

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'Favourite room' savoliga ajoyib javob uchun metafora: X is the heart of the home. Kitchen yoki living room haqida ishlating.

Namuna gap: For many families the kitchen is **the heart of the home**, because that's where everyone meets.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

21 do up

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ta'mirlab, bezab yangilamoq • *to repair and decorate an old place so it looks better*

BAND 8 STORY
My parents bought an old house and spent a whole summer **doing it up**. Dad repainted the walls while I sanded the doors, and now it looks nothing like the dark, damp place we first saw.

≈ **renovate** — ta'mirlamoq

≈ **give it a makeover** — yangi qiyofa bermoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(ko'ylak, tugma) bog'lamoq, qadamoq — Do your coat **up**; it's freezing outside.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Phrasal verb: do up a house / flat; ega o'rtada ham kelishi mumkin: do it up. Norasmiy, ko'proq ingliz tilida. Uy ta'miri haqida.

Namuna gap: My dream is to buy a cheap old flat and **do it up** myself.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 spruce up

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ozoda qilib, ko'rkamlashtirmoq • *to make a place look neater and nicer with small changes*

BAND 8 STORY
Before Navruz, we always **spruce up** the house. We wash the windows, put out fresh flowers and cook sumalak, so the whole home feels brand new for the holiday.

≈ **freshen up** — yangilamoq

≈ **smarten up** — ko'rkam qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kichik o'zgarishlar bilan yangilash: spruce up the garden / the living room. 'Do up' dan kichikroq ish uchun ishlating.

Namuna gap: A new rug and a few plants can **spruce up** even the dullest room.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 declutter

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ortiqcha narsalardan tozalamoq • *to remove things you do not need so a space is tidy*

BAND 8 STORY
Last spring I decided to **declutter** my bedroom after I couldn't find my passport under a pile of old notebooks. I gave away three bags of clothes and, surprisingly, I felt lighter in my mind too.

≈ **clear out** — tozalab tashlamoq

≈ **get rid of clutter** — tartibsizlikdan qutulmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: To'g'ridan-to'g'ri fe'l: declutter a room / my desk. Minimalizm haqida gapirganda ham mos; ot shakli: clutter (tartibsizlik).

Namuna gap: Once I started to **declutter**, I realised I owned five phone chargers I never used.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 tidy up

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

tartibga solmoq • *to put things in their place so a room looks neat*

BAND 8 STORY

Every Saturday morning my sister and I **tidy up** the whole flat before guests arrive. We put on loud music to make it fun, and by noon the place looks great and we have earned a long break.

≈ **put things away** — narsalarni joyiga qo'ymoq

≈ **straighten up** — tartibga keltirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tidy up (a room) yoki tidy up after someone (orqasidan yig'ishtirmoq). Kundalik uy ishlari haqidagi Part 1 savollarida ishlating.

Namuna gap: I try to **tidy up** a little every evening so the mess never builds up.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 knock down a wall

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

devorni buzmoq • *to break a wall so that two rooms become one*

BAND 8 STORY

When my uncle **knocked down the wall** between the kitchen and the dining room, the flat suddenly looked twice as big. The dust was terrible for a week, but he is still proud of the result.

≈ **knock through** — xonalarni birlashtirmoq

≈ **open up the space** — makonni kengaytirmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO

(narxni) tushirmoq — The shop **knocked** ten per cent **off** the price.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ta'mirni tasvirlashda: knock down a wall (butunlay buzmoq), knock through (ikki xonani birlashtirmoq). Part 2 da uy rejasini aytishda.

Namuna gap: If I ever buy a small flat, I'd **knock down a wall** to create one big living space.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 fitted wardrobes

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

devorga o'rnatilgan shkaflar • *cupboards for clothes built to fit exactly into a room*

BAND 8 STORY

My bedroom is small, so Dad installed **fitted wardrobes** that run along the whole wall. There is no wasted space now, and I finally have room for my winter coats without piling them on a chair.

≈ **built-in storage** — o'rnatilgan saqlash joyi

≈ **storage space** — saqlash joyi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Kichik uyda joyni tejash haqida: fitted (ingliz) yoki built-in (amerika) wardrobes. 'Furniture' sanalmaydi, lekin wardrobes sanaladi.

Namuna gap: In a small flat, **fitted wardrobes** make much better use of space than bulky furniture.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 put up shelves

5/10 SPEAKING BALL

javonlar o‘rnatmoq • *to fix shelves onto a wall*

BAND 8 STORY

I wanted more space for my books, so I **put up shelves** above my desk on my own. It took me the whole afternoon and one bent nail, but they are still standing, and I’m absurdly proud of them.

≈ **mount shelves** — javonlarni devorga mahkamlamoq

≈ **set up a study corner** — o‘qish burchagini tuzmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(mehmonni) tunash uchun joylashtirmoq — Can you **put me up** for a night while my flat is painted?

Qachon ishlatiladi: Put up = devorga o‘rnatmoq (shelves, curtains, a tent). Qarama-qarshisi: take down. Uy ishlari va mustaqillik haqida gapirganda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: My dad **put up shelves** in every room, so books are literally everywhere in our house.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 minimalist décor

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

minimalistik bezak • *a simple style of decoration with few objects and plain colours*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m drawn to **minimalist décor**: white walls, one plant and a wooden desk. When my room is empty like that, my mind is calmer, and I can focus on my IELTS practice for hours.

≈ **a clean, uncluttered look** — toza, ortiqcha narsasiz ko‘rinish

≈ **sleek design** — silliq zamonaviy dizayn

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uslub haqida: go for / opt for minimalist décor. ‘Décor’ sanalmaydi (a décor emas). Zamonaviy uy yoki xona tasvirida ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Her flat has **minimalist décor**, so it feels spacious even though it is tiny.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 handy around the house

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

uy ishlarida qo‘li gul • *good at fixing small things at home*

BAND 8 STORY

My father is really **handy around the house**; he fixed a leaking tap with a little tape and a lot of patience. When something breaks, we never call a plumber, and it has saved us a fortune.

≈ **good with my hands** — qo‘li ishga yaqin

≈ **a DIY enthusiast** — o‘zi qiladigan ishqibozi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Shaxs xususiyatini tasvirlash: be (quite) handy around the house. ‘Handy’ qulay degan ma’noni ham beradi (a handy tool).

Namuna gap: I’m not very **handy around the house**, so I always ask my uncle for help.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 rearrange the furniture

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

mebelni qayta joylashtirmoq • *to move furniture to new positions to change how a room looks*

BAND 8 STORY

Whenever I feel stressed, I **rearrange the furniture** in my room. It sounds silly, but a new layout makes the room feel fresh, and somehow my thoughts feel more organised too.

≈ **move things around** — narsalarning o‘rnini almashtirmoq

≈ **change the layout** — joylashuvni o‘zgartirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xonani arzon usulda yangilash haqida: rearrange the furniture / the layout. ‘Furniture’ sanalmaydi: a piece of furniture deb ayting.

Namuna gap: A quick way to refresh a room is to **rearrange the furniture**; it costs nothing.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Explaining why it matters (Part 2 reasons)

31 a space of my own

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

faqat o‘zimniki bo‘lgan joy • *a room or area that belongs only to you*

BAND 8 STORY

Sharing a room with two siblings, I dreamed of **a space of my own** where I could study in silence. When I finally got a tiny room at seventeen, I painted it blue and it felt like a palace.

≈ **my own little corner** — o‘zimning go‘shamim

≈ **some privacy** — shaxsiy hayot

Qachon ishlatiladi: Shaxsiy joy va privacy haqida: have a space of my/your/their own. Part 3 da yoshlar va ota-ona uyi mavzusida ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Teenagers especially need **a space of their own** to relax away from their parents.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 sentimental value

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

xotiraga bog‘liq qadr • *importance because of memories, not because of money*

BAND 8 STORY

My grandfather’s old wooden chest isn’t worth much, but it has huge **sentimental value** for me. He kept his letters in it, and every time I open it I can almost smell his tobacco and hear his stories.

≈ **personal significance** — shaxsiy ahamiyat

≈ **a keepsake** — esdalik buyum

Qachon ishlatiladi: Buyumga bog‘liq xotira: have / hold sentimental value (to someone). Narxi emas, xotirasi muhimligini aytish uchun Part 2 da juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: I would never sell the house because it has too much **sentimental value**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 bring up

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

(bolani) tarbiyalab katta qilmoq • *to look after a child until they are an adult*

BAND 8 STORY

My parents **brought** me **up** in a three-generation household, so I learned respect for elders very early. Everyone looked after everyone else, and I honestly can’t imagine a quieter, lonelier life.

≈ **raise** — tarbiyalamoq

≈ **be raised** — tarbiyalanmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(mavzuni) ko‘tarmoq, gapirib qoldirmoq — She **brought up** the idea of moving at dinner.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bring up a child (ingliz), raise (amerika). Ko‘pincha passivda: I was brought up in... Part 1 dagi oila va bolalik savollarida ishlating.

Namuna gap: I was **brought up** in a big house full of cousins, which is why I hate silence.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 fond memories of

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yoqimli xotiralar • *happy, warm memories of something in the past*

BAND 8 STORY

I have **fond memories of** my grandparents' courtyard with its big grapevine. We used to eat watermelon under it every August, and even now the smell of ripe grapes takes me straight back there.

≈ **cherish the memory of** — xotirasini qadrlamoq

≈ **feel nostalgic about** — sog'inib eslamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Have fond memories of + ot / -ing. Doim ko'plikda (memories). 'Good memories' o'rniga ishlating, bu Band 8 uchun yaxshiroq.

Namuna gap: I have **fond memories of** doing homework at the kitchen table while Mum cooked.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 a safe haven

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

xavfsiz, tinch panoh • *a place where you feel protected and calm*

BAND 8 STORY

After tough exam days, my room is **a safe haven** for me. I lock the door, put on soft music and nobody expects anything from me, which is the best medicine for stress.

≈ **a sanctuary** — muqaddas panoh

≈ **a refuge** — boshpana

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uy tashqi dunyodan panoh ekanini aytish uchun: a safe haven from + muammo (the noise, stress). Part 2 va Part 3 sabablarida.

Namuna gap: For many people, home is **a safe haven** from the pressure of work.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 escape the hustle and bustle

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

shovqin-suron va shoshilinchdan qochmoq • *to get away from the noisy, busy life of a city*

BAND 8 STORY

At weekends we drive to our village house to **escape the hustle and bustle** of Tashkent. There are no horns, only roosters, and by Sunday evening I feel ready for another week.

≈ **get away from it all** — hamma narsadan uzoqlashmoq

≈ **leave the rat race behind** — shov-shuvdan uzoqlashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Shahar shov-shuvini tasvirlash: escape / get away from the hustle and bustle of the city. Part 2 va Part 3 da keng qo'llanadi.

Namuna gap: A garden is the perfect place to **escape the hustle and bustle** of city life.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 recharge my batteries

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

kuch to‘plamoq, qayta quvvat olmoq • *to rest so that you have energy again*

BAND 8 STORY

Weekends at home are when I **recharge my batteries**. I sleep late, eat my mother’s food and don’t answer messages, and by Monday I’m ready to concentrate again.

≈ **recuperate** — kuch tiklamoq

≈ **get my energy back** — kuchimni qaytarib olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idioma: recharge my / your batteries. Dam olishning sababini tushuntirishda; ko‘p mavzularda (hobbi, safar, dam olish) ishlatish mumkin.

Namuna gap: Quiet time in my room is the best way for me to **recharge my batteries**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 a close-knit family

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

inoq, bir-biriga bog‘langan oila • *a family whose members are very close and support each other*

BAND 8 STORY

I come from **a close-knit family**, so even my cousins live on the same street. If anyone is ill, five people turn up with soup within an hour, and I would never swap that for a bigger house.

≈ **a tight-knit family** — juda inoq oila

≈ **a supportive family** — qo‘llab-quvvatlovchi oila

Qachon ishlatiladi: Oila munosabatlari: come from / belong to a close-knit family. Part 2 dagi ‘who would live there’ bandi uchun juda mos.

Namuna gap: Living in **a close-knit family**, I never feel lonely.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 a sense of security

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

xavfsizlik hissi • *the feeling of being safe and not worried*

BAND 8 STORY

Owning a home gave my parents **a sense of security** they never had when renting. They stopped worrying about landlords raising the price, and honestly they seem ten years younger.

≈ **peace of mind** — ko‘ngil tinchligi

≈ **stability** — barqarorlik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Give / provide a sense of security. Uy sotib olishning ahamiyatini tushuntirishda Part 3 da yaxshi.

Namuna gap: A stable home gives children **a sense of security** that helps them do better at school.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 bring the family together

6/10
SPEAKING BALL

oilani jamlamoq • *to make family members spend time with each other*

BAND 8 STORY

Dinner is the one moment that **brings the family together**. Everyone puts their phone away, my dad tells his terrible jokes, and even my teenage brother stays at the table.

≈ **unite the family** — oilani birlashtirmoq

≈ **get everyone around the table** — hammani dasturxon atrofiga yig'moq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Bring ... together: bring people / the family together. Bayramlar va ovqat haqida. Part 3 dagi 'What brings families together?' savolida mos.

Namuna gap: Festivals like Navruz **bring the whole family together** under one roof.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Part 3: housing trends and problems

COLLOCATIONS 5 / 5

41 a housing shortage

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

uy-joy tanqisligi • *a situation where there are not enough homes for people*

BAND 8 STORY

Many big cities face **a housing shortage**, and Tashkent is no exception. As more families arrive from the regions, new flats are snapped up in weeks, and young couples often end up living with their parents for years.

≈ **a lack of affordable housing** — arzon uy yetishmasligi

≈ **overcrowding** — haddan tashqari gavjumlik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 uchun: face / tackle / ease a housing shortage. Muammo va yechimni bir gapda aytishga yordam beradi; 'a' artikli bilan ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Unless the government builds more homes, **a housing shortage** will push prices even higher.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 soaring property prices

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko'chmas mulk narxlarining keskin oshishi • *very fast rises in the cost of homes*

BAND 8 STORY

Soaring property prices are the main reason my cousin still rents. She has saved for years, but by the time she had a deposit, the same flat cost almost double.

≈ **sky-high prices** — osmon baravar narxlar

≈ **a property boom** — ko'chmas mulk bumi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 iqtisodiy savollarda: property prices soar / have soared. 'Increase' dan ancha kuchli. Soar dan keyin 'up' kerak emas.

Namuna gap: **Soaring property prices** make it almost impossible for young people to buy.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 get on the property ladder

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

birinchi uyini sotib olmoq • *to buy your first home*

BAND 8 STORY

For my generation, it's very hard to **get on the property ladder**. Even with a good salary, we need a huge deposit, so many of my friends have given up and just rent for life.

≈ **become a homeowner** — uy egasi bo'lmoq

≈ **step onto the housing market** — uy bozoriga kirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ingliz idiomasi: get on the property ladder. Birinchi uy olish haqida; Part 3 dagi 'Should governments help young people...' savoliga mos.

Namuna gap: Cheaper loans would help first-time buyers **get on the property ladder**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 affordable housing

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

arzon (hamyonbop) uy-joy • *homes that ordinary people can pay for*

BAND 8 STORY
The city has started building **affordable housing** on the outskirts, and it's already changing lives. A teacher I know finally bought a two-room flat there, something she never imagined on her salary.

≈ **low-cost housing** — arzon uylar

≈ **social housing** — ijtimoiy uy-joy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 dagi asosiy birikma: provide / build affordable housing. 'Cheap housing' dan rasmiyroq va yaxshiroq eshitiladi.

Namuna gap: Governments should invest in **affordable housing** rather than luxury apartments.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 a hefty rent

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

og'ir (katta) ijara haqi • *a very large amount of money paid regularly to live in a place*

BAND 8 STORY
My friend pays **a hefty rent** for a tiny studio near the centre. After bills, he has almost nothing left, so he is thinking about moving further out and commuting.

≈ **a steep rent** — baland ijara haqi

≈ **an exorbitant rent** — haddan oshiq ijara haqi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Pay / charge a hefty rent. 'Hefty' = katta miqdordagi pul. Part 3 da shahar hayotining xarajatlari haqida gapirishda ishlating.

Namuna gap: Students often pay **a hefty rent** for rooms barely bigger than a cupboard.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 take out a mortgage

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ipoteka krediti olmoq • *to borrow money from a bank to buy a home*

BAND 8 STORY
My parents **took out a mortgage** twelve years ago to buy our flat. They still pay it every month, and Dad jokes that the bank owns the kitchen until 2030.

≈ **get a home loan** — uy krediti olmoq

≈ **buy on credit** — kreditga sotib olmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(kimnidir restoran, kafega) taklif qilmoq — He **took** her **out** for dinner on their anniversary.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Take out a mortgage / loan (get emas, take out). Pay off a mortgage = to'lab tugatmoq. Part 3 da uy sotib olish moliyasini muhokama qilishda.

Namuna gap: Most young couples can only buy a home if they **take out a mortgage**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 high-rise apartment blocks

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ko‘p qavatli turar-joy binolari • *very tall buildings with many flats*

BAND 8 STORY

Our old neighbourhood has been replaced by **high-rise apartment blocks**. They house many more families, but I miss the little gardens where kids used to play.

≈ **tower blocks** — baland minora uylar

≈ **multi-storey buildings** — ko‘p qavatli binolar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Shahar qurilishi haqida: high-rise buildings / blocks. ‘Tower block’ ba’zan salbiy ohangda. Part 3 dagi flats vs houses mavzusida.

Namuna gap: **High-rise apartment blocks** make sense in crowded cities because they use land efficiently.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 urban sprawl

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

shaharning nazoratsiz kengayishi • *the uncontrolled spread of a city into the countryside*

BAND 8 STORY

Because of **urban sprawl**, farmland around Tashkent is disappearing under new houses. People get cheaper homes, but they also spend two hours a day in traffic, so the saving isn’t real.

≈ **suburban expansion** — chekka hududlarning kengayishi

≈ **overdevelopment** — haddan ortiq qurilish

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 va ekologiya mavzularida: contribute to / lead to urban sprawl. Sanalmaydigan ot. Band 8 darajasidagi mavzuga oid so‘z.

Namuna gap: Better public transport can help to reduce **urban sprawl**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 the cost of living

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

yashash xarajatlari • *the amount of money people need for housing, food and other basics*

BAND 8 STORY

The **cost of living** in big cities keeps rising, and rent takes the biggest bite. My brother moved to Tashkent for work, and after paying for his room he can hardly save anything.

≈ **living expenses** — yashash xarajatlari

≈ **household bills** — uy-ro‘zg‘or hisoblari

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sanalmaydigan ibora: the cost of living is high / is rising (‘are’ emas). Part 3 dagi iqtisod va shahar hayoti savollarida.

Namuna gap: A high **cost of living** is one reason people leave the capital.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 fly the nest

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

ota-ona uyidan chiqib mustaqil yashamoq • *to leave your parents' home and start living on your own*

BAND 8 STORY

In many countries young people **fly the nest** at eighteen, but in Uzbekistan most stay until marriage. Personally, I think it's partly about money and partly about family closeness.

≈ **move out** — ko'chib chiqmoq

≈ **leave home** — uydan ketmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy idioma: fly the nest. Mustaqillik va ota-onadan ajralish haqida; Part 3 dagi 'young people living with parents' mavzusiga mos.

Namuna gap: Rising rents make it difficult for graduates to **fly the nest**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

STRUCTURES 1 / 2

1 What I love most about X is that...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Menga X ning eng yoqadigan jihati shuki... • *A cleft sentence that puts the main point first for emphasis*

BAND 8 STORY

What I love most about my flat **is that** it gets sunlight all day. In winter it feels warm even without heating, and I'm in a great mood every morning.

≈ **What I appreciate is...** — Men qadrlaydigan narsa...

≈ **The thing I like best is...** — Eng yoqadigan narsa...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 1 da fikrni ta'kidlash: What I love / like / enjoy most about + ot + is + that-gap yoki ot. 'Is' dan keyin gap kelsa 'that' qo'shing.

Namuna gap: **What I love most about** home **is** the smell of my mother's cooking when I walk in.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 The + comparative, the + comparative

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qancha ..., shuncha ... • *Shows that two things change together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more time I spend in my little room, **the more** I appreciate its quiet. And **the less** clutter I keep, **the easier** it is to concentrate on my studies.

≈ **As ..., so ...** — ... sari, shuncha ...

≈ **The sooner..., the better** — Qancha tez, shuncha yaxshi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki o'zgarish bog'liqligini bildiradi: The + qiyosiy daraja + gap, the + qiyosiy daraja + gap. Ikkala 'the' ni ham yozing; Part 3 trendlarida juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **The bigger** the city grows, **the harder** it becomes for young people to find a decent flat.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 N + preposition + which + S + V

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ichida/...da bo'lgan (predlogli nisbiy gap) • *A relative clause where the preposition comes before 'which' or 'whom'*

BAND 8 STORY

The room **in which** I spend most of my time is the kitchen. It's the place **to which** the whole family drifts after work, and that's where our best conversations happen.

≈ **the place where + S + V** — ... bo'lgan joy

≈ **the house (that) I grew up in** — men katta bo'lgan uy

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiyroq uslub: the house in which I grew up (= I grew up in). Predlog 'which' dan oldin turadi; 'in which' dan keyin 'that' ishlatilmaydi.

Namuna gap: The flat **in which** I grew up was tiny, yet it holds my happiest memories.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 so + adj + that / such + noun + that

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Shunchalik ... ki ... • *Shows a strong cause and its result*

BAND 8 STORY

The view from our balcony is **so** stunning **that** guests never want to leave. Last spring it was **such** a warm evening **that** we had dinner out there until midnight.

≈ **too ... to** — ...gina bo'lib, ... qila olmaydi

≈ **to the extent that** — shu darajadaki

Qachon ishlatiladi: So + sifat + that; such + (a/an) + sifat + ot + that. Natijani ta'kidlash uchun Part 2 da juda foydali. So sifat bilan, such ot bilan.

Namuna gap: Our flat is **so** small **that** I have to keep my bike on the balcony.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 It is said that... / X is widely regarded as...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Aytishlaricha ...; ... deb hisoblanadi • *Reports a general belief without saying who believes it*

BAND 8 STORY

It is said that a home is where your story begins, and I agree. My grandfather's house **is widely regarded as** the centre of the whole family, and every wedding starts and ends there.

≈ **It is believed that...** — ...ga ishoniladi

≈ **People tend to think that...** — Odamlar ... deb o'ylashadi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da umumiy fikrni bildirish: It is said / believed / thought that + gap; X is said / widely regarded as + ot. Passiv, akademik ohang.

Namuna gap: **It is widely believed that** owning a home brings stability.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 Not only + inversion + but also...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Nafaqat ..., balki ... • *Adds a second strong point; the first part uses question word order*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only is my ideal house close to nature, **but** it **is also** designed to save energy. Solar panels cover the roof, so we would hardly pay any bills.

≈ **Not only that, but...** — Shu emas, balki...

≈ **As well as being..., it is...** — ...ham, ... ham

Qachon ishlatiladi: Inversion: Not only + is / does / has + ega, keyin but ... also. Part 2 da sabab qo'shishda; ega tartibi savolga o'xshaydi.

Namuna gap: **Not only does** a garden look beautiful, **but** it also keeps the house cool.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 If + had p.p., would + V (mixed conditional)

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lmaganida, hozir ... edi • *Mixes a past condition with a present result*

BAND 8 STORY

If we hadn't moved to this district, **I would** still **be** commuting two hours a day. That move changed everything, because now I have time for exercise and for English practice.

≈ **Had it not been for..., I would...** — ...bo'lmaganida, men ... edim

≈ **If I hadn't..., I wouldn't have...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida, ... bo'lmas edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Aralash shart gap: If + had p.p. (o'tmish sharti), would + V (hozirgi natija). Hayotni o'zgartirgan voqeani tasvirlashda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **If my parents hadn't bought** this flat, we **would** probably **be** renting somewhere far away now.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Had + S + p.p., S + would have + p.p.

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lganida, ... bo'lar edi (if siz) • *A formal third conditional without 'if'*

BAND 8 STORY

Had I known the old house would be demolished, **I would have taken** more photos. Now all I have is a faded picture of the courtyard, and I treasure it more than anything.

≈ **If I had known, I would have...** — Bilganimda, ... edim

≈ **Had it not been for...** — ...bo'lmaganida

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiy uchinchi shart: 'if' tashlanadi, 'had' ega oldiga o'tadi. O'tmishdagi afsus haqida; Part 2 hikoyalarda ajoyib.

Namuna gap: **Had we saved** more, **we would have bought** a bigger house.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Were it not for + noun, S + would...

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lmaganida (rasmiy) • *Says that something prevented a different result*

BAND 8 STORY

Were it not for my neighbours, I would have felt lonely in my first month in the city. They brought me bread, helped me carry boxes and invited me for tea, so the flat quickly felt like home.

≈ **But for + noun** — ...bo'lmaganida

≈ **Without + noun** — ...siz

Qachon ishlatiladi: Were it not for + ot (rasmiy); suhbatda: If it weren't for. Faqat 'were' ishlatiladi, 'was' emas. Kimdir yoki nimadir yordam bergani haqida.

Namuna gap: **If it weren't for** the lift, living on the ninth floor would be impossible.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 I wish + past / If only + past

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

Kaski edi ...; Faqat ... bo‘lsa edi • *Expresses a wish about a present situation that you want to change*

BAND 8 STORY

I wish my flat **had** a balcony, because on summer evenings it gets unbearably hot inside. **If only** we had chosen the top floor, we could at least catch a breeze.

≈ **It’s high time + past** — ...vaqti keldi

≈ **I’d rather + S + past** — ... bo‘lsa yaxshi edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Wish + o‘tgan zamon (hozirgi afsus); wish + had p.p. (o‘tmish afsusi); wish + would (shikoyat). ‘Was’ o‘rniga ‘were’ ham to‘g‘ri.

Namuna gap: **I wish** I **lived** closer to my university; the commute is exhausting.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Having + p.p., S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

... qilib bo‘lgach, ... • *A participle clause for an earlier action that explains the next one*

BAND 8 STORY

Having lived in cramped rooms for years, I now value every square metre. So when I describe my ideal home, I always begin with space, light and a door I can close.

≈ **After + -ing** — ...dan keyin

≈ **Once I had + p.p.** — ... qilib bo‘lgach

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikkala gapda ega bir xil bo‘lishi shart. Having + p.p.: sabab yoki ketma-ketlik. Part 2 hikoyalarida yozma uslubni beradi, so‘zlashuvda ham mos.

Namuna gap: **Having grown up** in the mahalla, I find the silence of big cities quite strange.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 used to / would + V

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

Avval ... qilar edim (odat) • *Talks about past habits that are no longer true*

BAND 8 STORY

When I was little, we **used to** sleep on the floor in the courtyard during hot summers. Mum **would** lay out thick blankets, and we’d count stars until we fell asleep.

≈ **There was a time when...** — Bir paytlar ... edi

≈ **I’d often...** — Ko‘pincha ... qilardim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Used to: odat va holat uchun; would: faqat takrorlanuvchi harakat uchun (holat bilan emas: ‘would live’ xato). Bolalikni eslashda ishlating.

Namuna gap: I **used to** share a room with my brother, so I really value my privacy now.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe your ideal house.

Describe your ideal house.

You should say:

- where it would be
- how big it would be and what rooms it would have
- who would live there
- why it is ideal for you

My 1-minute notes

- outskirts of Samarkand • near old city • no traffic
- two storeys • big windows • plenty of light
- open-plan kitchen • four bedrooms • study
- garden • apricot trees • weekend barbecue
- future family • parents • close-knit
- safe haven • recharge • sense of belonging

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what, where)	I'd like to talk about my ideal house, which I've been imagining since I was a teenager. It would be a two-storey home with a big garden, and as for the location, I'd build it on the edge of Samarkand, a stone's throw from the old city but far from the traffic and noise.
P • Size and rooms	When it comes to size, I'm not after a mansion, but I do want plenty of space. Downstairs there would be an open-plan kitchen and living room with floor-to-ceiling windows, so we'd get plenty of natural light all day. Upstairs I'd have four bedrooms and a quiet study, because I need a space of my own to read and prepare for exams. And of course there would be a garden with apricot trees, where I could cook up a storm at weekends.
P • Who would live there	As for who would live there, it would be my future family and, hopefully, my parents. I come from a close-knit family, so the idea of living far from them has never appealed to me. Having grown up with my grandparents under one roof, I know how much warmth that brings, and I'd love my own children to experience it too.
E • Reason 1	The first reason it's ideal is that it would be a safe haven for me. After a long day, I could unwind in the garden and escape the hustle and bustle of the city, which is exactly how I recharge my batteries.
E • Reason 2	On top of that, the house would bring the family together. The more space we have, the easier it is to host relatives during Navruz, and I'd love the kitchen to be the heart of the home, just like my grandmother's.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, my ideal house isn't about luxury. Were it not for the people inside it, it would just be bricks and glass, but with them it would give me a sense of belonging that I can't imagine anywhere else.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
a nice house	a cosy, well-designed home
very big	spacious / plenty of space
very clean	spotlessly clean
near the shops	within walking distance of the shops
I relax at home	I unwind / recharge my batteries
houses are expensive	property prices have soared
buy a first home	get on the property ladder
a kitchen with lots of space	an open-plan kitchen
big windows	floor-to-ceiling windows
a lot of light	plenty of natural light
close to the shops	a stone's throw from the shops
a quiet area	a quiet residential area
I like being at home	I feel at home
I sit and relax	I kick back
I cook a lot	I cook up a storm
clean up the room	tidy up the room
throw away things I don't need	declutter
make the room nicer	spruce up the room
I made shelves	I put up shelves
I'm good at fixing things	I'm handy around the house
it means a lot to me	it has sentimental value
a place where I feel safe	a safe haven
leave the noisy city	escape the hustle and bustle
life is expensive	the cost of living
move out of my parents' home	fly the nest